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The 150th anniversary of the first-ever Test match will be celebrated with a day-night fixture between Australia and England at the Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG) in March 2027. The MCG hosted the first Test ever played in 1877 and the centenary match between Australia and England 100 years later. Australia won both matches by 45 runs. The 150th anniversary match will be the first men's Test played under lights at the 100,000-capacity venue. England will also tour Australia for a five-Test Ashes series later this year.



3

Steve Smith announced his retirement from One-Day International cricket after top-scoring in Australia's ICC Champions Trophy semifinal against India. One of Australia's most accomplished ODI players, Smith debuted in 2010 as a leg-spinning all-rounder before evolving into a batting mainstay. In over 170 matches, he amassed 5,800 runs at an average of 43.28, including 12 centuries and 35 fifties, while also claiming 28 wickets. A key figure in Australia's 2015 and 2023 World Cup-winning campaigns, Smith captained the ODI side from 2015 and led the team on an interim basis in his final match.



4

Bangladesh wicketkeeper Mushfiquur Rahim has announced his retirement from One-Day Internationals following his team's group-stage exit from the ICC Champions Trophy 2025. Rahim made his ODI debut against Zimbabwe in August 2006 and retired as the most-capped Bangladesh player in the format, with 274 matches to his name. He scored 7,795 runs — the second-most in ODIs for Bangladesh after Tamim Iqbal — including 49 fifties and nine centuries. As a wicketkeeper, he took 243 catches and effected 56 stumpings.



5

Harry Brook has pulled out of this year's Indian Premier League, citing his commitment to playing for England. The 26-year-old was signed by Delhi Capitals at last year's IPL auction for Rs 6.25 crore but has now withdrawn for the second consecutive season, potentially putting him at risk of a two-year ban from the tournament.



6

Michael Bracewell will captain New Zealand in the upcoming five-match T20I series against Pakistan, set to begin in Christchurch this month. Bracewell, who played a key role in New Zealand's journey to the Champions Trophy final, is among seven players from that squad named for the home series. He steps in for regular skipper Mitch Santner, who is unavailable due to IPL commitments.